

# The Ban Fell, the Book Stood

Edwin Giltay

**Abstract** In 2016 the Court of Appeal of The Hague lifted a complete publication and speaking ban imposed in 2015 on the Dutch non-fiction book *De doofpotgeneraal* (*The Cover-up General*), explicitly dismissing doubts about the meticulousness with which it was written. This essay traces the affair the book documents: a military intelligence operation surrounding suppressed photographic evidence of the 1995 Srebrenica genocide, the infiltration of a civilian workplace in Delft, and an almost three-decade pattern of institutional silence. It sets out how the book served as evidence in the Mothers of Srebrenica's litigation against the Dutch State, which culminated in the Supreme Court's 2019 ruling on partial state liability, and it documents the contradictory positions taken by successive ministers. The essay argues that the persistent refusal of the ministries involved to respond substantively is itself the story: documented truth facing institutional denial.

**Keywords:** Srebrenica, censorship, press freedom, military intelligence, cover-up, the Netherlands

*The events in this affair are so bizarre that, without documentation, they could easily give the impression of paranoia. That is precisely why virtually every fact in this essay is verifiable.*

## A Unique Precedent

On 12 April 2016, the Court of Appeal of The Hague issued a landmark ruling: it lifted both the full ban on *The Cover-up General* and the speaking ban on its author. But the court did more than restore freedom of speech: "Unlike the preliminary relief judge, the Court of Appeal holds that these inaccuracies [an age and the spelling of a name] are also insufficient to cast doubt on the meticulousness with which [author Edwin Giltay] proceeded in writing the book".<sup>1</sup> The claimant, a former employee of military intelligence service MID who appears in it, had also demanded that Giltay declare his own work pure fiction in three national newspapers. The court established precisely the opposite. The role she plays in the book is not "purely invented" or "complete fiction".<sup>2</sup>

This combination, a total ban reversed with the judicial rehabilitation of the author, is virtually unequalled. The Banned Books Museum calls it "a very rare example in our collection of an author who successfully challenged a book ban".<sup>3</sup> That same judgment, moreover, sums up the book's core claim, in the court's own words, that "the roll of film with photographs that a soldier of Dutchbat [the Dutch UN battalion] took in Srebrenica was not destroyed by accident, but was deliberately withheld by the MID". The court did not establish its truth, but it did rule that the claim belongs to "a debate of public interest" and that a ban would affect "the fundamental freedom of expression at its core".<sup>4</sup>

In Dutch legal history, this precedent is unique. While writers like the nineteenth-century Dutch author Multatuli triumphed over attacks on specific passages, *The Cover-up General* is, as far as is known, the only Dutch book whose total ban<sup>5</sup> was

judicially reversed. That reversal was possible because the ban was legally weak, the subject matter of direct public importance, and the evidence overwhelming. For instance, the claimant reproached the author for a spelling error in her name, while correspondence surfaced that proved in black and white that she had misspelled her own name.<sup>6</sup> The legal victory, however, is only part of the story. What makes this case significant is what the book brings to light, and how the government has responded. Or more precisely, how it hasn't.

What this essay says about the author is not there because his case weighs more heavily than that of the bereaved. It is there because discrediting the messenger has for almost thirty years been the way to keep the message shut out: where did the Srebrenica photographs go?

### **The Government Contradicts Itself**

The Dutch government's response to this judicially scrutinised book reveals a striking internal contradiction. The Minister of Justice stated in 2021 that *The Cover-up General* is "in no way" considered fake news, conspiracy theory or anti-government propaganda.<sup>7</sup> He thereby ruled out all three disqualifying labels, in line with the 2016 ruling. Yet in 2018, the Minister of Defence dismissed it as a book in which "fact and fiction do indeed become intertwined".<sup>8</sup> This confronts the public with an impossible choice.

The failure to speak with one voice is constitutionally problematic. Dutch ministers are obliged to maintain consistent government policy, yet here they take opposing positions on the same work, whose meticulousness the court had already confirmed in 2016. One minister acknowledges its factual basis while another dismisses it as a blend of truth and fabrication. Who is correct: the Minister of Justice, or the Minister of Defence who has refused clarification for decades? In 2017, the Parliamentary Defence Committee unanimously decided that the Minister of Defence should provide a substantive response to the book's allegations.<sup>9, 10</sup> Yet that answer has never come. Can a government serve as arbiter of truth when its own ministers contradict each other?

### **What the Book Reveals: Srebrenica Cover-Up**

What prompted this institutional silence? *The Cover-up General* documents in precise detail how a Dutch military intelligence operation spiralled out of control. This operation involved surveillance of civilians at their workplace and the suppression of photographic evidence related to the 1995 Srebrenica genocide, in which over 8,000 Bosniaks (Bosnian Muslims) were murdered after Dutch UN troops failed to protect their enclave. The film captured Bosnian Serb war crimes, evidence that the Dutch military sought to obscure.<sup>11</sup>

The book recounts how this operation began with military intelligence officer Barbara Overduyn's infiltration of Giltay's civilian workplace in Delft in 1998, involving incidents that included a break-in and photographic surveillance.<sup>12</sup> She had approached Giltay while openly discussing internal opposition within her intelligence service to the suppression of the Srebrenica photos. The roll, she said, had not failed at all: it was simply "stored in the archives of the MID".<sup>13</sup>

After Giltay filed a complaint with the National Ombudsman, Overduyn accused him of being “irritating”, “maladjusted” and “completely insane”.<sup>14</sup> She made those statements in an investigation the MID opened into itself. That was agreed within the service on 26 January 1999, between its deputy head and the Ombudsman’s case officer.<sup>15</sup> In his response to the Ombudsman, the Minister of Defence adopted the report of that self-investigation, drawn up on the instructions of that same deputy head, as his official position. In doing so, the Ministry shifted the focus: to a complaint about Defence it answered with a judgement on the complainant’s character.

Giltay reported these ministerial statements as libel to the Chief Public Prosecutor in June 1999.<sup>16</sup> Two weeks later, both the Head of the Military Intelligence Service and his deputy were removed from their posts by the Minister over a “serious error of judgement”.<sup>17, 18</sup> When Giltay, assisted by lawyer Gerard Spong,<sup>19</sup> also sought to file a criminal complaint with the police in July 1999, the detectives refused to record it. In March 2000 the district chief upheld Giltay’s grievance about this on two points and offered his apologies.<sup>20</sup> Only then, in June 2000, was the complaint of slander and libel recorded by The Hague police.

In that complaint Giltay also put on record what Overduyn had said about the photographic material: “Unprompted, she stated that the failure of the so-called failed development of the photographs taken was a fabrication, and that she had seen the photos herself”.<sup>21</sup> Later that year, Giltay sought the help of Her Majesty Queen Beatrix over the stalling of this Srebrenica-related criminal complaint. An intervention followed: she referred his letter to the Minister of the Interior for handling.<sup>22</sup> This prompted The Hague’s mayor Wim Deetman to formally acknowledge to Giltay that his police force had acted wrongly towards him.<sup>23, 24</sup>

However, the Minister’s characterisation remains online today, in the National Ombudsman’s public report of 1999.<sup>25</sup> This despite considerable contradictory evidence: a Defence assessment from 1998 that attested to a strong character,<sup>26</sup> professional references from multinationals including IBM and Deloitte,<sup>27, 28, 29, 30</sup> the court’s recognition of Giltay’s working method,<sup>31</sup> and Overduyn’s own later admission that her claims were refuted.<sup>32</sup> Although the characterisation has never been withdrawn, Minister of Defence Ank Bijleveld bluntly denied in 2018 that Defence had ever spoken of Giltay in such terms.<sup>33</sup> That this characterisation was in fact made is recorded not only in that report. Since August 1999 it has been set down in black and white at the Public Prosecution Service.<sup>34</sup> It has been on the court record since 2002: a decision of the Court of Appeal of The Hague recorded at the time that Overduyn, “working at the MID”, had indeed declared that Giltay was “completely insane”.<sup>35</sup>

## **A Cover-Up with an International Dimension**

While the libel case remained a domestic matter, the cover-up surrounding the photographic material reached into international justice. At the International Criminal Tribunal for the former Yugoslavia in The Hague, the roll of film came up in the trial of Radovan Karadžić, the Bosnian Serb leader who was sentenced to life imprisonment in part for the genocide in Srebrenica. In 2011, during the testimony of Johannes Rutten, the lieutenant of Dutchbat III who on 13 July 1995 photographed the bodies of executed Bosniaks at Potočari, it was recorded that on his return he

handed his roll of film over to the MID. He was subsequently told that the photos had failed to develop.<sup>36</sup>

It was counter-intelligence Major De Ruyter who took receipt of the roll.<sup>37</sup> The NIOD report, the official inquiry into the fall of Srebrenica commissioned by the cabinet, records that, during training, he had told the battalion that the population of the enclave consisted of “nothing but scum”.<sup>38</sup> The same major conducted the February 1999 interview with Overduyn from which the ministerial position emerged that Giltay was “completely insane”.<sup>39</sup> On 6 December 2002 he testified under oath about the fate of that same roll before the Parliamentary Committee of Inquiry on Srebrenica.<sup>40</sup> The dehumanisation of the Muslim population, the vanished evidence and the branding of the witness as insane thus share not only a ministry, but a single official.

Rutten’s roll does not stand alone. In late 2016, lawyers Klaas Arjen Krikke and Michael Ruperti announced that, on behalf of more than two hundred members of Dutchbat III, they would seek a court order for access to photographic material which they said lies in the archive of the Military Intelligence and Security Service (MIVD), as the MID is now called: prints of at least eight rolls of film.<sup>41</sup> Whether that claim was ever filed has never become public. Under Chapter VII of the UN Charter, all states, the Netherlands included, were obliged to cooperate fully with the tribunal, up to and including the production of evidence.<sup>42</sup> When Giltay asked the Tribunal about the rolls,<sup>43</sup> the Office of the Prosecutor replied on 3 October 2017 that it had no knowledge of the “8 photo rolls”.<sup>44</sup> The prosecutors who brought the genocide cases thus knew nothing of them.

How much weight the Dutch failure in Srebrenica carries was settled politically long ago: in 2002 the entire cabinet resigned following the NIOD report.<sup>45</sup> The rolls of film belong to that same dossier. De Ruyter maintained in his hearing before the parliamentary committee of inquiry that Rutten’s roll had failed during development: it was, in his words, an accumulation of “situations in which Murphy’s law struck”, in short “just bad luck”.<sup>46</sup> Yet that account remained contested, despite multiple official investigations, even within the armed forces themselves. Former Dutch army commander General Hans Couzy gave his own account in 1998: the MID wanted to develop it itself, after which it was lost there. He called it “a story that naturally no one believes”.<sup>47</sup>

Hans Laroës, former editor-in-chief of NOS News (Dutch public television news), also wrote about the film roll in his 2014 epilogue to *The Cover-up General*: “Nobody I talked to believed any of it. There was no journalist around who did not doubt the official line, with a hint of cynicism”.<sup>48</sup> The 2015 total ban covered his epilogue too. Thus, even his widely shared scepticism was silenced at the time.

## **More Than a Banned Book**

The international attention *The Cover-up General* received reflects not only curiosity about a banned title, but also concern about what it reveals: evidence of institutional cover-up in the aftermath of the Srebrenica genocide. In July 2015, the Mothers of Srebrenica cited it as an illustration of precisely the cover-up pattern it describes. In their memorandum of grievances against the Dutch State it appears in the passage

on the destruction of photographic and video material.<sup>49</sup> That was no coincidence: their lawyers had followed the book from the outset.<sup>50</sup> Simon van der Sluijs attended the launch of the first edition in November 2014, and as early as February 2015 he and his colleague Marco Gerritsen put their weight behind it: “Edwin Giltay describes how his rights were sacrificed by the State in order to keep the cover-up surrounding the Srebrenica film roll sealed. Once again, the suspicion is fed that the State is responsible for the disappearance of the notorious film roll”.<sup>51</sup>

Even before *The Cover-up General* appeared, it had won support from an unimpeachable quarter: former Minister Jan Pronk, who took political responsibility for the failure of the Dutch UN mission in Srebrenica, called it “meticulously written and well documented”.<sup>52</sup> Although the State did not refute the book’s content in the Mothers’ lawsuit, the book did not go unchallenged in military intelligence circles. By her own account, Overduyn approached the Ministry of Defence, which turned out to be aware of the work but decided not to take action itself.<sup>53</sup> Overduyn then demanded a complete publication and speaking ban, which the District Court imposed in December 2015.<sup>54</sup> Prohibited were not only distribution, publication and reprinting, but also further promotion of the book “at lectures, book presentations and other public utterances”, under penalty of up to €100,000. The ban thereby affected even Giltay’s freedom to speak about his own life.

Giltay defended himself with media lawyer Jurian van Groenendaal at his side,<sup>55</sup> after which the Court of Appeal overturned the ban in 2016. In 2019, in the Mothers’ case, the Supreme Court established Dutch liability at ten per cent of the damages suffered by the surviving relatives of approximately 350 men who were sent away from the Dutchbat compound on 13 July 1995.<sup>56</sup>

For the surviving relatives it came to a fraction of what they had claimed; two years earlier the Court of Appeal had still put liability at thirty per cent.<sup>57</sup> In that same memorandum of grievances their lawyers had already written that it “at the very least has the appearance that the State, through the intervention of the military intelligence and security service, deliberately destroyed or is withholding the photos in question from the notorious film roll”.<sup>58</sup> For the claim that Rutten’s film roll had never failed, they referred to four pages from *The Cover-up General*.<sup>59</sup>

The book’s impact extends far beyond the courtroom. The censorship backfired: the attempt to ban it propelled the story around the world.<sup>60, 61</sup> Giltay added eight chapters on the battle against censorship to the second edition,<sup>62</sup> and two more to the third. Over four hundred publications, in print media, radio, television and online, from Brazil to Indonesia, have by now reported on the book.<sup>63</sup> That press attention is not a tribute but a question asked time and again that the Ministry of Defence leaves unanswered: what did the Military Intelligence Service have to hide?

### Three Affairs

At a single civilian workplace in Delft, the traces of three affairs in postwar Dutch history converged: Srebrenica, the IRT affair (a 1990s Dutch policing scandal), and a secret honey-trap programme. These were not parallel dossiers. They intersected there.

In the same small department of the civilian company that Overduyn infiltrated in 1998, another woman also worked there, who had ended up in a life-threatening situation. She had fled her provincial town as a result, as Giltay heard in 1998. Moreover, as he learned in 1999 from an entirely different source, she had been placed in a witness protection programme by the Ministry of Justice. (For the safety of his former colleague, Giltay remained silent about this until 2026 and leaves further substantiation aside here.) Through no fault of her own, she had become caught up in a corruption scandal surrounding the IRT affair, in which police and prosecutors infiltrated organised drug crime. While the Ministry of Justice had supported her as a protected witness in building a new life, the Ministry of Defence subsequently turned her workplace in Delft into a covert observation post for an intelligence operation.

In other words, the left hand of the State compromised what the right hand was supposed to protect. The monitoring of the threatened witness at this workplace remained out of Giltay's sight, as Overduyn, during her infiltration, directed his interest towards her intelligence service and Srebrenica. The fact that this intelligence operation was taking place directly alongside the 'protected' civilian woman was explained away to Giltay in 1999 as mere coincidence. This coincidence had, however, aroused intelligence interest in the department.<sup>64</sup> This raises the question of whether the State had an independent interest in monitoring this woman, given her role as a witness in a state corruption case.

*The Cover-up General* not only exposes these intelligence operations. The book, whose meticulousness was validated by the Court of Appeal of The Hague,<sup>65</sup> also describes a separate honey-trap programme run by the Dutch Domestic Security Service (BVD), which was kept from Parliament and for which Giltay was approached in 1992.<sup>66</sup> In 2015, the Minister of the Interior, Ronald Plasterk, responsible for the BVD's successor, stated that he had taken note of the manuscript. He added: "I shall not respond substantively to this any further".<sup>67</sup> At the author's request, however, he ordered an official investigation by the CTIVD, the oversight committee for the intelligence services,<sup>68</sup> which he withdrew 46 days later.<sup>69</sup>

The convergence of three affairs may help explain why the State has remained so persistently silent: acknowledging the findings on the Military Intelligence Service would lend credibility to the revelations about the Domestic Security Service, and vice versa. Moreover, acknowledging that the State neglected its duty of care surrounding witness protection could call the entire programme into question. The result is a government speaking with three voices: rejection (Defence), silence (Interior) and confirmation without substantive explanation (Justice).

### **Never a Substantive Answer**

This pattern is not a recent development. Despite the judicial validation and international impact of the book, the ministries named within it have never responded substantively to its revelations, at any level. The silence began even before publication. As early as 30 October 2000, the Minister of Defence rejected a request for rehabilitation with the closing line: "No further letters from you will be answered".<sup>70</sup>

On 20 November 2010, the author sent a confidential letter<sup>71</sup> to the parliamentary group leaders Job Cohen, Stef Blok and Geert Wilders, at the time also members of the Committee on the Intelligence and Security Services. Enclosed was a detailed witness report of this affair, an early manuscript version of *The Cover-up General*. What happened to the letter after it was received, Giltay never learned. Six weeks later, on the night of 31 December 2010 to 1 January 2011, a fire broke out in Giltay's storage unit in The Hague, situated in a locked storage corridor alongside and beneath six flats. The police recorded the fire as arson.<sup>72</sup> His paper dossier was lost in the fire; digital copies, however, have been preserved at multiple locations. A connection to the content of his testimony is unlikely but cannot be ruled out: the perpetrator has never been traced.

More than three years later, in March 2014, the Ministers of Defence and of the Interior received the full manuscript of *The Cover-up General* ahead of publication, accompanied by a formal notification and a deadline for a response, confirmed by a signed acknowledgement of receipt.<sup>73, 74</sup> That the manuscript was sent to both ministers before publication with a request to respond has moreover stood, since 2016, as an undisputed fact in the appeal judgment.<sup>75</sup> The ministers chose not to reply. There was no substantive response upon publication, nor when the ban was lifted in 2016 with judicial praise.

In June 2017, the Ministry of Defence rejected a request to retract the 1999 ministerial declaration of insanity, citing the Ombudsman report from that same year and a CTIVD investigation. Both bodies were said to have declared Giltay's complaints about the MIVD unfounded.<sup>76</sup>

Both pillars of this position, however, had been refuted years earlier. The Ombudsman report had been undermined when the Court of Appeal of The Hague explicitly dismissed the doubts about the author's meticulousness.<sup>77</sup> Moreover, within two months of the report's publication, the Ombudsman himself had already written to Giltay: "It is not the case that the National Ombudsman regards the account of the former MID employee concerned as absolute truth, and your account thereby as untrue".<sup>78</sup> The CTIVD investigation, the second pillar, did not exist, and this had been on the record since 2009: two successive chairs had confirmed at the time that the committee had not handled Giltay's complaint, because Defence had never submitted the request for advice that this required.<sup>79, 80</sup> General Onno Eichelsheim, Director of the MIVD and Chief of Defence since 2021, ultimately confirmed this himself. He wrote to Giltay in October 2017: "The CTIVD has not handled any complaint from you against the MIVD. There is therefore no CTIVD report either".<sup>81</sup>

Likewise in 2017, the Parliamentary Defence Committee unanimously demanded that the Minister address the allegations. That decision had been preceded by an intervention by Speaker of the House Khadija Arib: she forwarded Giltay's letter to the Standing Committee on Defence.<sup>82</sup> The official ministerial reply that followed, however, sidestepped the military intelligence affair entirely.<sup>83</sup> Minister Ank Bijleveld, asked about the case in 2018, simply stated: "Defence has no further opinion on that".<sup>84</sup> After the Supreme Court of the Netherlands ruled in 2019 that the Netherlands is partially liable for around 350 Srebrenica deaths,<sup>85</sup> in the case in which the Mothers' lawyers relied on the book, Giltay again heard nothing from Defence. In 2020, he formally invited Defence once more to answer on the merits, this time with

a view to a translation.<sup>86</sup> The Minister replied that she “has no need to respond substantively to your book”, without giving any legal grounds for that refusal.<sup>87</sup>

In 2021, the Minister of Justice denied in writing that the term “danger to the State” applies to the book or its author.<sup>88</sup> With that, there is no legal justification for the disruption measures to which Giltay has been subjected since 1998: for they are, after all, aimed precisely at activities “dangerous to the State”, according to the handbook *Informatie en Opsporing* (‘Information and Investigation’).<sup>89</sup> The Ministers of Defence and the Interior were, moreover, free to argue that state secrets, military security interests or ongoing operations stood in the way of publication of *The Cover-up General*. The Ministry of Defence did not do so in 2014. A week later, the Ministry of the Interior did not do so either. The same was true in 2015, when Minister Plasterk refused to respond substantively to Giltay’s repeated notification about the honey-trap programme. The CTIVD investigation he opened at the author’s request was withdrawn 46 days later without any invocation of state security. Nor did Defence invoke that ground in 2020.

In short, seven moments, three ministries, one pattern: not one invocation of a state secret. This silence is not statutory secrecy. It is a choice. When Defence, in June 2017, did give reasons for refusing to withdraw the declaration of insanity, it invoked not state security but the refuted Ombudsman report and a CTIVD investigation that did not exist. Nor did that reasoning address the content of the book. And when the Minister, at Parliament’s request, did briefly address the book in October 2017, he dismissed the film-roll thesis with the 2002 NIOD report and said nothing about the intelligence affair, again without invoking state security. Without that invocation, the last legal ground on which the disruption measures still seemed defensible falls away.

In 2022 Giltay delivered the third revised edition in person for the attention of the new Minister of Defence, Kajsa Ollongren, with a covering letter in which he expressed the hope that she would set right the mistakes of her predecessors.<sup>90</sup> No response came from Defence. The silence extends even to the film roll. Although Agfa photo experts in Munich concluded that the roll had been so thoroughly destroyed that this could only have been done deliberately,<sup>91</sup> Defence persists with the narrative of a development error, and has never revised that position. It is not the only destruction of documentation in this affair that has remained officially unexplained.

### **The Silence Is the Story**

This persistence creates an unprecedented asymmetry: the gulf between documented establishment of the facts and the enduring absence of institutional accountability remains unbridged. In a functioning democracy with robust accountability mechanisms, such sustained refusal to engage with a book that has withstood judicial scrutiny would be impossible. That it continues is not a gap in this story. It *is* the story.

The situation resembles a chess match where one player, facing inevitable checkmate, simply refuses to make another move. What happens when a player neither acknowledges the evidence nor refutes it? They avoid formal defeat, but does that



change the outcome? Whoever surveys the board can judge the position for themselves. The silence of the ministries reveals precisely the cover-up mentality this book exposes: an institutional inability to confront uncomfortable truths about controversial intelligence operations, one of which is linked to the greatest failure in modern Dutch history. And the audience grows. Every new publication, in whatever language, gathers new witnesses around the board.

## Obstruction Backfires

In 2023, Giltay once again scored victories over state obstruction. The National Ombudsman had literally locked away his file “in the safe”.<sup>92</sup> In 2018, after the judicial rehabilitation, Giltay had submitted nine specific grievances to the National Ombudsman, backed up by a dossier of 19 pieces of evidence. He had also previously delivered copies of his book, containing extensive additional documentation, to the Ombudsman’s office, partly at the request of its own staff.<sup>93</sup> The Ombudsman, however, refused to address the grievances on the merits and unilaterally ended the correspondence with a one-page letter: further letters would be archived without reply.<sup>94</sup>

The Hague District Court punished this obstruction in 2023. It ruled that the institution had wrongfully blocked Giltay’s information request,<sup>95</sup> and in a subsequent ruling even imposed penalty payments.<sup>96</sup> In paying that penalty in 2024, the National Ombudsman made a calculation error, which he refused to correct for years.<sup>97</sup> Only on 11 June 2026, three days after Giltay had announced that he would otherwise put the matter before the civil court, did he acknowledge his error.<sup>98</sup> The supplementary payment followed 28 months after the initial payment.<sup>99, 100</sup>

With the court-ordered funds, Giltay financed the translation and free worldwide distribution of the English edition,<sup>101</sup> turning state obstruction into global accessibility. In 2024, this international edition was launched at the Banned Books Museum in Tallinn, Estonia, which added it to its collection next to the ‘banned’ Dutch edition.<sup>102</sup> The story kept surfacing in unexpected places. In 2025, Grok, the chatbot of Elon Musk’s company xAI, publicly endorsed *The Cover-up General* on X.<sup>103</sup> By xAI’s account this was its first corporate book recommendation.<sup>104</sup>

In the archives, too, this affair is now irreversibly recorded. In June 2026, the national library KB selected the book’s documentary website for inclusion in its web collection,<sup>105</sup> in line with the UNESCO Charter on the Preservation of the Digital Heritage.<sup>106</sup> From 12 July 2026, the day after the Srebrenica commemoration, the site was archived, including the e-books and source documents published there, and thereby preserved beyond the author’s reach in the Depot of Dutch Publications. That same month, both editions were deposited in the archive of CERN in Geneva,<sup>107, 108</sup> so that they remain permanently accessible and citable. The book now sits in the collections that preserve the very history it describes: from the Peace Palace in The Hague<sup>109</sup> and the NIOD Institute for War, Holocaust and Genocide Studies in Amsterdam<sup>110</sup> to the National and University Library in Sarajevo<sup>111</sup> and the Srebrenica Memorial Centre in Potočari.<sup>112</sup>

Giltay’s case is included in an ongoing study by Prof. Andrew Hales of the University of Mississippi into the effects of book censorship.<sup>113</sup> At home, *The Cover-up*

*General* features on the recommended-reading list of Week van het Verboden Boek,<sup>114</sup> the free-expression campaign which this year runs from 19 to 27 September. Each new repository adds a witness to the same unanswered question, while clarification from the Ministry of Defence remains absent.

## Cracks in the Wall

Notably, *The Cover-up General* sits on the shelves of three Defence libraries: the Royal Military Academy, the Royal Naval College, and the Netherlands Institute of Military History.<sup>115</sup> The Ministry of Defence makes it available for its own officers to read.

Even the Ministry's own people have contradicted its 1999 declaration of insanity. As early as 1998, its own psychological assessment concluded Giltay had a strong character,<sup>116</sup> the opposite of mentally unstable. In 2016, Overduyn acknowledged in court documents that Giltay had disproved her claims with evidence.<sup>117</sup> Yet the Ministry's response to Giltay's 2017 retraction request was unequivocal: "I therefore consider your case closed".<sup>118</sup> A year later, Minister of Defence Ank Bijleveld publicly praised Giltay's military acuity in a social media exchange.<sup>119</sup>

This pattern of contradiction extends even to the oversight body itself. The interview reports in the 1999 Ministry of Defence document were incorporated word for word, as the Minister's official position, into a public Ombudsman report.<sup>120</sup> Yet a quarter century later, in 2024, the institution's own senior legal counsel Karin Vaalburg praised *The Cover-up General*. A former lieutenant colonel who represented the Ombudsman against Giltay in related court cases, she wrote in her work correspondence: "My compliments on the very extensive underlying documentation and level of detail in the story!"<sup>121</sup> This on-the-record praise came from the very institution whose 1999 report remains online today.

## End the Silence for Srebrenica

*The Cover-up General* has been challenged, brushed aside and met with silence, but never substantively refuted. It is a work of investigative journalism that held up before the Court of Appeal, that opponents acknowledge and that the Ministry of Justice has not designated as fake news. A genuine controversy exists only when two sides exchange arguments. Here one side put hundreds of documents on the table, while the other maintained almost three decades of obstruction and silence. Is that a controversy, or documented truth facing institutional denial?

The pillars of the democratic rule of law provide the book's decisive validations. Six independent authorities substantiate what the Ministry of Defence refuses to acknowledge:

1. **Survivors:** Srebrenica survivors cited the book as evidence in their proceedings against the State, in the passage on the destruction of photographic and video material.<sup>122</sup>
2. **Judiciary:** The Court of Appeal lifted the publication and speaking bans and explicitly dismissed the doubts cast on the book's meticulousness.<sup>123</sup>

3. **Parliament:** Parliament acknowledged the gravity of the matter by unanimously demanding answers from the Minister of Defence.<sup>124</sup>
4. **Justice:** The Minister of Justice confirmed it is not disinformation.<sup>125</sup>
5. **Oversight:** The senior legal counsel of the National Ombudsman, whose institution lost twice to Giltay in court, praised the book's documentation in her official capacity.<sup>126</sup>
6. **Procedure:** The court ruled that this Ombudsman unlawfully blocked Giltay's information request,<sup>127</sup> corroborating the book's pattern of institutional obstruction.

Beyond the book itself, the professional references and the military assessment of the author's character, both cited above, stand unchallenged too. None of it could be contested by the Ministry of Defence's key witness, who had sought to ban the book: she acknowledged in court documents that her specific claims about the author had been disproved by evidence. Yet the Ministry of Defence continues to maintain her refuted position even after her death in 2024.<sup>128</sup>

But this is no longer about one whistleblower's credibility. This is about whether a democratic state can continue to contradict its own courts, its own Minister of Justice, its own victims, and the documented historical record. The Ministry's refusal to retract its refuted report is not merely personal: it hampers investigation into the intelligence scandal surrounding the genocide. As long as discrediting the messenger remains state policy, the message itself can never be addressed. Personal rehabilitation is not the end goal, but an indispensable prerequisite for historical responsibility.

### No Other Option Left

On 25 March 2026, the author spoke with Judge Solomy Balungi Bossa of the International Criminal Court. As keynote guest, she participated in a public debate at Amare, The Hague,<sup>129</sup> within sight of the Ministry of Defence. In the context of Srebrenica and this book, he asked her what she thought of those who cover up evidence of war crimes. Her answer was unambiguous: "They should be brought to justice".<sup>130</sup>

At stake is accountability for Srebrenica. This book supplied the Mothers of Srebrenica with evidence for their claim that the photographs of the genocide are being withheld. In 2019, the Supreme Court of the Netherlands ruled that the Dutch State is partially liable for the deaths of about 350 men. The Ministry of Defence's continued radio silence creates the impression that institutional self-preservation outweighs historical truth about Europe's only genocide since the Holocaust.

For Srebrenica survivors today, this means over thirty years of struggle since 11 July 1995 to obtain the answers they deserve. For Dutchbat veterans, this means waiting for the release of their photographs, which they took at the time, some at personal risk, only for them to be seized.<sup>131</sup> For the Ministry of Defence, this means a deadlocked position in which silence is becoming increasingly costly, legally, morally, and geopolitically. That is also literally true: fighting the Srebrenica cases cost the

State over 2.6 million euros in legal fees between 2003 and 2021, figures that became public after a freedom-of-information request by the author.<sup>132</sup>

Truth requires courage, especially when it touches a national trauma. That courage deserves recognition when it comes. Transparency ultimately offers the only sustainable way forward: not as a threat to the officials involved, but as a prerequisite for institutions to regain public trust.

There is no other option left: end the silence about Srebrenica. The truth about the genocide deserves no less. The mothers are still waiting.

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## Endnotes

- <sup>1</sup> Court of Appeal of The Hague, judgment of 12 April 2016, case no. 200.183.987/01, ECLI:NL:GHDHA:2016:870, para. 4.9; <https://deeplink.rechtspraak.nl/uitspraak?id=ECLI:NL:GHDHA:2016:870>; an unofficial English translation is available at [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/arrest-en.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/arrest-en.pdf).
- <sup>2</sup> Ibid., paras 3.1 and 4.10.
- <sup>3</sup> Banned Books Museum, Tallinn, video on *The Cover-up General*, 2024; <https://vimeo.com/935927986>.
- <sup>4</sup> Court of Appeal of The Hague, judgment of 12 April 2016, ECLI:NL:GHDHA:2016:870, para. 4.5; <https://deeplink.rechtspraak.nl/uitspraak?id=ECLI:NL:GHDHA:2016:870>.
- <sup>5</sup> District Court of The Hague, judgment in preliminary relief proceedings of 14 December 2015, case no. C/09/497903 / KG ZA 15/1556, ECLI:NL:RBDHA:2015:15050 (complete publication ban); <https://uitspraken.rechtspraak.nl/details?id=ECLI:NL:RBDHA:2015:15050>; an unofficial English translation is available at [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/censuurvonnis-en.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/censuurvonnis-en.pdf).
- <sup>6</sup> Court of Appeal of The Hague, judgment of 12 April 2016, ECLI:NL:GHDHA:2016:870, para. 4.9; <https://deeplink.rechtspraak.nl/uitspraak?id=ECLI:NL:GHDHA:2016:870>.
- <sup>7</sup> Letter from the Minister of Justice and Security to Giltay, 12 January 2021, ref. 3175305, in reply to his letter of 23 November 2020 asking whether the classifications in Dreigingsbeeld Terrorisme Nederland 53 applied to his book 'or myself', confirming that it is 'in no way' considered fake news, conspiracy theory or anti-government propaganda; both letters are in the PDF; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/justitie.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/justitie.pdf).
- <sup>8</sup> Jeroen Stam, 'Defensie flatert voort' [Defence keeps blundering on], *Novini*, a Dutch online opinion platform, 25 August 2018, containing the statement by the Minister of Defence; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/novini.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/novini.pdf).
- <sup>9</sup> Letter from the parliamentary Standing Committee on Defence to Giltay, 18 September 2017, ref. 2017Z09359/2017D25719, 'Verzoek om opheldering over Srebrenica-doofpotaffaire' [Request for clarification of the Srebrenica cover-up affair], recording the committee's decision of 14 September 2017 to ask the Minister of Defence for a response to Giltay's letter of 1 June 2017; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/commissie.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/commissie.pdf).
- <sup>10</sup> 'Dutch Parliament: The Military Must Answer', *Hart van Nederland*, the news programme of commercial broadcaster SBS6, television item of 14 September 2017, on the Defence Committee's unanimous demand for a substantive ministerial response; <https://vimeo.com/462739433>.
- <sup>11</sup> 'Foto's Srebrenica bewust vernield' [Srebrenica photos deliberately destroyed], *Trouw*, a Dutch daily newspaper, 29 June 2006, on the technical investigation into the film roll; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/trouw.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/trouw.pdf).
- <sup>12</sup> Edwin Giltay, English synopsis of *The Cover-up General* (4 pages); [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/English%20Synopsis.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/English%20Synopsis.pdf).
- <sup>13</sup> Edwin Giltay, *The Cover-up General* (The Hague: author, 2024), p. 24; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/book.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/book.pdf).
- <sup>14</sup> Military Intelligence Service (MID), internal report 'Intern onderzoek GILTAY' [Internal investigation GILTAY], no. Det/51/99, 12 February 1999, containing Overduyn's claims; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/chef-staf-mid.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/chef-staf-mid.pdf).
- <sup>15</sup> Letter from the Ministry of Defence, Directorate of Legal Affairs, to the National Ombudsman, 2 March 1999, ref. CNO 99/001 (first page only), on the arrangement made at the MID on 26 January 1999; the chief of staff of the MID named in it was also the deputy head of the service; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/barth1999.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/barth1999.pdf).
- <sup>16</sup> Formal complaint (*klaagschrift*) from Giltay to the Chief Public Prosecutor in The Hague, 28 June 1999, regarding the ministerial libel;

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[www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/klaagschrift.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/klaagschrift.pdf).

<sup>17</sup> 'De Grave zet leiding MID aan de kant' [De Grave sidelines MID leadership], *de Volkskrant*, a Dutch daily newspaper, 14 July 1999; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/MID-top.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/MID-top.pdf).

<sup>18</sup> *NOS Journaal*, the Dutch public broadcaster's television news, 13 July 1999, 8 p.m. bulletin, opening item 'Minister De Grave ontslaat top militaire inlichtingendienst MID' [Minister De Grave dismisses the leadership of military intelligence service MID], presented by Pia Dijkstra, including a statement by De Grave; <https://schatkamer.beeldengeluid.nl/serie/2101608030021675031/journaal/aflevering/2101608080064630031>.

<sup>19</sup> Letter from G. Spong, Wladimiroff & Spong Advocaten, to Giltay, 28 May 1999, on prosecuting the MID official concerned for libel; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/spong.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/spong.pdf).

<sup>20</sup> Letter from the district chief of the Haaglanden police to Giltay, 26 March 2000, upholding his grievance on two points and offering apologies; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/laagland.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/laagland.pdf).

<sup>21</sup> Haaglanden Police, official report of criminal complaint (proces-verbaal van aangifte) by Giltay, 12 June 2000 (first page only); [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/aangifte2000.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/aangifte2000.pdf).

<sup>22</sup> Letter from the Cabinet of Her Majesty the Queen, 31 October 2000, ref. Rek 00.003477, in reply to Giltay's letter of 14 October 2000; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/koningin.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/koningin.pdf).

<sup>23</sup> Letter from W.J. Deetman, Mayor of The Hague, 14 December 2000, declaring Giltay's objection concerning the police's conduct well-founded in part; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/deetman.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/deetman.pdf).

<sup>24</sup> Letter from the Ministry of the Interior (Police Directorate), 11 January 2001, ref. EA2000/95374, concluding the complaint about the police; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/afdoeningsbrief.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/afdoeningsbrief.pdf).

<sup>25</sup> National Ombudsman, Report 1999/507 of 17 December 1999, section C.5 (containing the ministerial characterisation); [www.nationaleombudsman.nl/uploads/rapporten/19990507\\_1998.07789.pdf](http://www.nationaleombudsman.nl/uploads/rapporten/19990507_1998.07789.pdf).

<sup>26</sup> National Ombudsman, telephone note of 7 October 1999, dossier 98.07789, on the military psychological examination; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/karakter.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/karakter.pdf).

<sup>27</sup> Casema testimonial (*getuigschrift*) signed by G.M. Doedée, Vice-President Human Resources, 8 June 1999; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/bijlage4.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/bijlage4.pdf).

<sup>28</sup> Randstad Callflex reference letter, May 1999; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/bijlage6.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/bijlage6.pdf).

<sup>29</sup> IBM Nederland reference letter, 18 October 1994; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/ibm.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/ibm.pdf).

<sup>30</sup> Deloitte & Touche Consulting feedback form by appraiser Charles Vivian, 6 April 2000; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/deloitte.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/deloitte.pdf).

<sup>31</sup> Court of Appeal of The Hague, judgment of 12 April 2016, ECLI:NL:GHDHA:2016:870, para. 4.9; <https://deeplink.rechtspraak.nl/uitspraak?id=ECLI:NL:GHDHA:2016:870>.

<sup>32</sup> Barbara Overduyn, *memorie van antwoord* (statement of defence on appeal), Court of Appeal of The Hague, 2 February 2016, point 36; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/memorie.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/memorie.pdf).

<sup>33</sup> Jeroen Stam, 'Defensie flatert voort' [Defence keeps blundering on], *Novini*, a Dutch online opinion platform, 25 August 2018, in which Minister Bijleveld denies that Defence ever declared Giltay insane; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/novini.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/novini.pdf).

<sup>34</sup> Letter from the Public Prosecutor's Office in The Hague to Giltay, 26 August 1999, ref. STAF/HO 871 00088, recording Overduyn's statements as made in the course of an

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investigation by the MID; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/om1999.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/om1999.pdf).

<sup>35</sup> Court of Appeal of The Hague (review chamber, Art. 12 Code of Criminal Procedure), decision of 19 December 2002, no. 01065K09; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/beschikking.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/beschikking.pdf).

<sup>36</sup> International Criminal Tribunal for the former Yugoslavia, *Prosecutor v. Radovan Karadžić*, hearing transcript of 28 November 2011, testimony of Johannes Rutten, pp. 21985–21986; [www.icty.org/x/cases/karadzic/trans/en/111128ED.htm](http://www.icty.org/x/cases/karadzic/trans/en/111128ED.htm).

<sup>37</sup> Parliamentary Committee of Inquiry on Srebrenica, public hearing of De Ruyter, 6 December 2002, Parliamentary Papers II 2002/03, 28 506, no. 5, p. 697, where he states that he personally collected the roll of film from Rutten; [zoek.officielebekendmakingen.nl/kst-28506-5.pdf](http://zoek.officielebekendmakingen.nl/kst-28506-5.pdf).

<sup>38</sup> NIOD Institute for War, Holocaust and Genocide Studies, *Srebrenica: een 'veilig' gebied* (Amsterdam: Boom, 2002), p. 1489, on the briefing given by Major De Ruyter, quoting adjutant W. Dijkema; [www.inlichtingendiensten.nl/buitenland/srebrenicarapportniod\\_nl.pdf](http://www.inlichtingendiensten.nl/buitenland/srebrenicarapportniod_nl.pdf).

<sup>39</sup> Military Intelligence Service (MID), internal report 'Intern onderzoek GILTAY', no. Det/51/99, 12 February 1999, recording the interview with Overduyn of 11 February 1999 and signed by Major R.F.J.H. de Ruijter; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/chef-staf-mid.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/chef-staf-mid.pdf). The spelling of his surname varies across the sources: the Parliamentary Committee of Inquiry used 'De Ruyter', while he signs this report with the 'ij' variant. The radio programme Argos identified him as counter-intelligence Major Rob de Ruyter and named him together with his liaison officer E. Rave, the same pair who drew up this report. Such variation is a professional practice rather than an inconsistency in the record: the handbook *Informatie en Opsporing* instructs agents that they may act 'under cover of an assumed identity or capacity, for example by using a false name' (D. van der Bel, A.M. van Hoorn and J.J.T.M. Pieters, *Informatie en opsporing*, Zeist: Kerckebosch, 2009), and the names of intelligence officers are in many cases deliberately misspelled, a false spelling being less far-reaching than an entirely new cover identity. See Edwin Giltay, *The Cover-up General* (The Hague: author, 2024), pp. 144 and 161–162; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/book.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/book.pdf).

<sup>40</sup> Parliamentary Committee of Inquiry on Srebrenica, public hearing of De Ruyter, 6 December 2002, Parliamentary Papers II 2002/03, 28 506, no. 5, pp. 695–701; [zoek.officielebekendmakingen.nl/kst-28506-5.pdf](http://zoek.officielebekendmakingen.nl/kst-28506-5.pdf).

<sup>41</sup> ANP, 'Nog veel meer fotorolletjes uit Srebrenica in archief MIVD' [Many more rolls of film from Srebrenica in the MIVD archive], 28 November 2016, published by *ThePostOnline*; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/achtrolletjes.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/achtrolletjes.pdf).

<sup>42</sup> United Nations Security Council, Resolution 827 (1993) of 25 May 1993, para. 4, establishing the obligation of all states to cooperate fully with the International Criminal Tribunal for the former Yugoslavia; [docs.un.org/en/S/RES/827\(1993\)](http://docs.un.org/en/S/RES/827(1993)).

<sup>43</sup> E-mail from Giltay to the Office of the Prosecutor of the International Criminal Tribunal for the former Yugoslavia, 24 September 2017; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/icty2017vraag.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/icty2017vraag.pdf).

<sup>44</sup> E-mail from Ljiljana Piteša, Media Relations, Office of the Prosecutor of the International Criminal Tribunal for the former Yugoslavia, to Giltay, 3 October 2017; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/icty2017.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/icty2017.pdf).

<sup>45</sup> Parliamentary Committee of Inquiry on Srebrenica, report, Parliamentary Papers II 2002/03, 28 506, no. 3, p. 7, §1.1.2: following the NIOD report, the second Kok cabinet tendered its resignation on 16 April 2002; [zoek.officielebekendmakingen.nl/kst-28506-3.pdf](http://zoek.officielebekendmakingen.nl/kst-28506-3.pdf).

<sup>46</sup> Parliamentary Committee of Inquiry on Srebrenica, public hearing of De Ruyter, 6 December 2002, Parliamentary Papers II 2002/03, 28 506, no. 5, pp. 698–701;



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[zoek.officielebekendmakingen.nl/kst-28506-5.pdf](https://zoek.officielebekendmakingen.nl/kst-28506-5.pdf).

<sup>47</sup> *Argos*, a Dutch investigative radio programme (VPRO Radio 1), broadcast of 10 July 1998, General Hans Couzy on the film roll; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/couzy.m4a](https://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/couzy.m4a).

<sup>48</sup> Edwin Giltay, *The Cover-up General* (The Hague: author, 2024), p. 206 (Hans Laroes, epilogue to the second edition); [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/book.pdf](https://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/book.pdf).

<sup>49</sup> Mothers of Srebrenica, memorandum of grievances (*memorie van grieven*) against the Dutch State, 7 July 2015, pp. 22–25 (in Dutch); [https://vandiepen.com/wp-content/uploads/2023/07/15-mvs\\_grievens\\_7-7-2015.pdf](https://vandiepen.com/wp-content/uploads/2023/07/15-mvs_grievens_7-7-2015.pdf).

<sup>50</sup> Email from Marco Gerritsen, counsel to the Mothers of Srebrenica, to Giltay, 24 November 2014, registering his colleague Simon van der Sluijs for the launch of the first edition and conveying the lawyers' early interest in the book; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/aanmelding.pdf](https://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/aanmelding.pdf).

<sup>51</sup> Email from Marco Gerritsen and Simon van der Sluijs, counsel to the Mothers of Srebrenica, to publisher SpeakEasy, 17 February 2015, containing their endorsement; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/gerritsen.pdf](https://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/gerritsen.pdf).

<sup>52</sup> E-mail from Jan Pronk to Giltay, 31 July 2014, approving the quotation for use with the book; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/pronk.pdf](https://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/pronk.pdf).

<sup>53</sup> Barbara Overduyn's writ of summons (*dagvaarding*) against Giltay in preliminary relief proceedings, 2015; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/dagvaarding.pdf](https://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/dagvaarding.pdf).

<sup>54</sup> District Court of The Hague, judgment in preliminary relief proceedings of 14 December 2015, case no. C/09/497903 / KG ZA 15/1556, ECLI:NL:RBDHA:2015:15050, operative part (the prohibition and the €100,000 penalty); <https://uitspraken.rechtspraak.nl/details?id=ECLI:NL:RBDHA:2015:15050>.

<sup>55</sup> 'Court of Appeal session', clip from 'The forbidden book', a television item by *ThePostOnline*, a Dutch news and opinion website, 11 April 2016; <https://vimeo.com/463063058>.

<sup>56</sup> Supreme Court of the Netherlands, judgment of 19 July 2019, case no. 17/04567, ECLI:NL:HR:2019:1223, para. 4.7.9; <https://deeplink.rechtspraak.nl/uitspraak?id=ECLI:NL:HR:2019:1223>.

<sup>57</sup> Court of Appeal of The Hague, judgment of 27 June 2017, ECLI:NL:GHDHA:2017:1761, paras 68 and 69.1; <https://deeplink.rechtspraak.nl/uitspraak?id=ECLI:NL:GHDHA:2017:1761>.

<sup>58</sup> Mothers of Srebrenica, memorandum of grievances, 7 July 2015, p. 14 (in Dutch); [https://vandiepen.com/wp-content/uploads/2023/07/15-mvs\\_grievens\\_7-7-2015.pdf](https://vandiepen.com/wp-content/uploads/2023/07/15-mvs_grievens_7-7-2015.pdf).

<sup>59</sup> *Ibid.*, p. 23.

<sup>60</sup> Index on Censorship, 'Netherlands: Court bans book on Srebrenica genocide', registering the ban on its Mapping Media Freedom platform (with the European Federation of Journalists and Reporters Without Borders) as a verified press-freedom violation, 24 December 2015; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/indexoncensorship.pdf](https://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/indexoncensorship.pdf).

<sup>61</sup> Kasseler Liste, the University of Kassel's international index of censored and banned books, entry for *De doofpotgeneraal / The Cover-up General* recording the 2015 ban and its 2016 reversal, added 17 August 2026; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/kasselerliste.pdf](https://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/kasselerliste.pdf).

<sup>62</sup> 'Forbidden book published again', video of the presentation of the revised second edition, at which Giltay handed the first copy to journalist Philip Dröge, 16 September 2016; <https://vimeo.com/465911601>.

<sup>63</sup> For a selection of the media coverage, see the Appendix at the end of this article.

<sup>64</sup> Edwin Giltay, *The Cover-up General* (The Hague: author, 2024), p. 73; e-book freely available at [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/book.pdf](https://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/book.pdf).



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- <sup>65</sup> Court of Appeal of The Hague, judgment of 12 April 2016, ECLI:NL:GHDHA:2016:870, para. 4.9; <https://deeplink.rechtspraak.nl/uitspraak?id=ECLI:NL:GHDHA:2016:870>.
- <sup>66</sup> Edwin Giltay, *The Cover-up General* (The Hague: author, 2024), pp. 46–47 and 81–86; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/book.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/book.pdf).
- <sup>67</sup> Letter from the Ministry of the Interior, 5 February 2015, signed by the Secretary-General on behalf of Minister Plasterk, declining to respond substantively; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/nietreageren.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/nietreageren.pdf).
- <sup>68</sup> Letter from the Ministry of the Interior, 2 March 2015, referring Giltay's complaint to the CTIVD for investigation; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/minBZK-1.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/minBZK-1.pdf).
- <sup>69</sup> Letter from the Ministry of the Interior, 17 April 2015, withdrawing the CTIVD investigation; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/minBZK-2.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/minBZK-2.pdf).
- <sup>70</sup> Letter from the Secretary-General on behalf of the Minister of Defence to Giltay, 30 October 2000, ref. CNO 99/001 / 2000004399, rejecting his request for rehabilitation; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/staken.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/staken.pdf).
- <sup>71</sup> Letters from Giltay to Job Cohen, Stef Blok and Geert Wilders, members of the Committee on the Intelligence and Security Services (CIVD), 20 November 2010, each enclosing his witness report; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/civd.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/civd.pdf).
- <sup>72</sup> Haaglanden Police, official report of criminal complaint (*proces-verbaal van aangifte*) no. PL1512 2011002721-1, 4 January 2011, recording arson; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/brandstichting.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/brandstichting.pdf).
- <sup>73</sup> Letter from Giltay to the Minister of Defence, 10 March 2014, delivered in person, with signed acknowledgement of receipt; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/minDef-aanbieding.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/minDef-aanbieding.pdf).
- <sup>74</sup> Letter from Giltay to the Minister of the Interior, 18 March 2014, delivered in person, with signed acknowledgement of receipt; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/minBZK-aanbieding.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/minBZK-aanbieding.pdf).
- <sup>75</sup> Court of Appeal of The Hague, judgment of 12 April 2016, ECLI:NL:GHDHA:2016:870, para. 2.5; <https://deeplink.rechtspraak.nl/uitspraak?id=ECLI:NL:GHDHA:2016:870>.
- <sup>76</sup> Letter from the Ministry of Defence (mr. J.J. Buirma), 6 June 2017, ref. BS2017018158, refusing to retract the 1999 ministerial characterisation; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/buirma.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/buirma.pdf).
- <sup>77</sup> Court of Appeal of The Hague, judgment of 12 April 2016, ECLI:NL:GHDHA:2016:870, para. 4.9; <https://deeplink.rechtspraak.nl/uitspraak?id=ECLI:NL:GHDHA:2016:870>.
- <sup>78</sup> Letter from the National Ombudsman to Giltay, 11 February 2000, on his report of 17 December 1999; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/relativering.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/relativering.pdf).
- <sup>79</sup> Letter from the CTIVD, 12 January 2009, ref. 2009/0008, confirming that the committee had not handled Giltay's complaint; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/ctivd1.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/ctivd1.pdf).
- <sup>80</sup> Letter from the CTIVD, 27 October 2009, ref. 2009/0212; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/ctivd2.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/ctivd2.pdf).
- <sup>81</sup> Letter from Major General O. Eichelsheim, Director of the MIVD, on behalf of the Minister of Defence, 24 October 2017, ref. DIS2017019472: 'The CTIVD has not handled any complaint from you against the MIVD. There is therefore no CTIVD report either'; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/bijlage19.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/bijlage19.pdf).
- <sup>82</sup> Letter from the Speaker of the House of Representatives, Khadija Arib, 27 June 2017, forwarding Giltay's letter of 1 June 2017 to the Standing Committee on Defence; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/arib.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/arib.pdf).
- <sup>83</sup> Minister of Defence, letter to the House of Representatives of 13 October 2017, parliamentary document 2017D29046; <https://zoek.officielebekendmakingen.nl/nds-tk-2017D29046.pdf>.

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- <sup>84</sup> Jeroen Stam, 'Defensie flatert voort' [Defence keeps blundering on], *Novini*, a Dutch online opinion platform, 25 August 2018, citing Minister Bijleveld's refusal to comment; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/novini.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/novini.pdf).
- <sup>85</sup> Supreme Court of the Netherlands, judgment of 19 July 2019, ECLI:NL:HR:2019:1223; <https://deeplink.rechtspraak.nl/uitspraak?id=ECLI:NL:HR:2019:1223>.
- <sup>86</sup> Letter from Giltay to Minister of Defence Bijleveld, 29 June 2020, delivered in person, requesting a substantive response; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/viermaal.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/viermaal.pdf).
- <sup>87</sup> Letter from the Ministry of Defence (Directorate of Communication), 29 July 2020, stating that Defence 'has no need to respond substantively' to the book; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/geenbehoefte.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/geenbehoefte.pdf).
- <sup>88</sup> Letter from the Minister of Justice and Security to Giltay, 12 January 2021, ref. 3175305, in reply to his letter of 23 November 2020 asking whether the classifications in Dreigingsbeeld Terrorisme Nederland 53 applied to his book 'or myself'; both letters are in the PDF; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/justitie.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/justitie.pdf).
- <sup>89</sup> Handbook *Informatie en Opsporing* [Information and Investigation], on disruption measures directed at activities 'dangerous to the State'; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/informatie-opsporing.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/informatie-opsporing.pdf).
- <sup>90</sup> Letter from Giltay to Minister of Defence Ollongren, 26 April 2022, delivered in person with the third revised edition; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/mist.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/mist.pdf).
- <sup>91</sup> 'Foto's Srebrenica bewust vernield' [Srebrenica photos deliberately destroyed], *Trouw*, a Dutch daily newspaper, 29 June 2006, on the technical investigation into the film roll; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/trouw.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/trouw.pdf).
- <sup>92</sup> National Ombudsman, internal note of 18 May 2017, dossier 1999.07789, recording that the file was kept in the safe; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/kluis.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/kluis.pdf).
- <sup>93</sup> Letter from Giltay to the National Ombudsman, 13 March 2018, setting out nine grievances with 19 exhibits; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/verzoekschrift.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/verzoekschrift.pdf).
- <sup>94</sup> Letter from the National Ombudsman, Reinier van Zutphen, 10 April 2018, ref. H201700015, in reply to Giltay's letter of 13 March 2018, announcing that further letters would be archived without reply; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/ombudsman2018.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/ombudsman2018.pdf).
- <sup>95</sup> District Court of The Hague (preliminary relief judge), judgment of 18 July 2023, cases SGR 23/4662 and SGR 23/4663, ECLI:NL:RBDHA:2023:17841; <https://deeplink.rechtspraak.nl/uitspraak?id=ECLI:NL:RBDHA:2023:17841>.
- <sup>96</sup> District Court of The Hague, judgment of 27 December 2023, case SGR 23/6997, ECLI:NL:RBDHA:2023:20409 (imposing penalty payments); <https://deeplink.rechtspraak.nl/uitspraak?id=ECLI:NL:RBDHA:2023:20409>.
- <sup>97</sup> Email from Karin Vaalburg, senior legal counsel of the National Ombudsman, to Giltay, 28 February 2024, ref. SGR 23/6997, maintaining that the correct penalty payment had been received; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/weigering.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/weigering.pdf).
- <sup>98</sup> Email from the National Ombudsman to Giltay's legal representative, 11 June 2026, ref. SGR 24/1777, acknowledging that one day too few had been counted and €1,900 paid instead of €2,000; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/fouterkenning.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/fouterkenning.pdf).
- <sup>99</sup> ING bank statement recording the National Ombudsman's payment of 16 February 2024 of €1,900 in penalty payments, case SGR 23/6997; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/bankafschrift.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/bankafschrift.pdf).
- <sup>100</sup> ING bank statement recording the National Ombudsman's supplementary payment of €100 on 26 June 2026, case SGR 23/6997; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/nabetaling.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/nabetaling.pdf).
- <sup>101</sup> Edwin Giltay, *The Cover-up General* (The Hague: author, 2024), free e-book; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/book.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/book.pdf).

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- <sup>102</sup> ‘Forbidden book now freely available’, Banned Books Museum, Tallinn, 2024, on the launch of the English edition and its addition to the museum’s collection; <https://vimeo.com/935927986>.
- <sup>103</sup> Grok (xAI) on X, endorsement of 4 November 2025; <https://x.com/grok/status/1985507338372202650>.
- <sup>104</sup> xAI confirmation of its official corporate recommendation on X, 6 November 2025; <https://x.com/grok/status/1986563860116185346>.
- <sup>105</sup> Koninklijke Bibliotheek (KB), the National Library of the Netherlands, notification of selection of [dedoofpotgeneraal.nl](http://dedoofpotgeneraal.nl) for the national web collection, ref. 38826057, 12 June 2026 (email, on file with the author); first archived from 12 July 2026.
- <sup>106</sup> UNESCO, *Charter on the Preservation of the Digital Heritage*, 2003; <https://unesdoc.unesco.org/ark:/48223/pf0000179529>.
- <sup>107</sup> Edwin Giltay, *De doofpotgeneraal*, e-book deposited in Zenodo (CERN), July 2026, DOI 10.5281/zenodo.21116205; <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.21116205>.
- <sup>108</sup> Edwin Giltay, *The Cover-up General*, e-book deposited in Zenodo (CERN), July 2026, DOI 10.5281/zenodo.21115325; <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.21115325>.
- <sup>109</sup> Peace Palace Library, The Hague, catalogue record, retrieved 23 March 2026; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/vredespaleis.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/vredespaleis.pdf).
- <sup>110</sup> NIOD Institute for War, Holocaust and Genocide Studies, Amsterdam, library catalogue record, retrieved 23 March 2026; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/niod.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/niod.pdf).
- <sup>111</sup> National and University Library of Bosnia and Herzegovina, Sarajevo, COBISS catalogue record (COBISS.BH-ID 69836038), retrieved 26 July 2026; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/nubbih.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/nubbih.pdf).
- <sup>112</sup> Edwin Giltay, *The Cover-up General* (The Hague: author, 2024), endnote 287, documenting the donation of two copies to the library of the Srebrenica Memorial Centre by peace organisation PAX; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/potocari.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/potocari.pdf).
- <sup>113</sup> Email from Prof. Andrew Hales, University of Mississippi, to Giltay, 1 July 2025, confirming the study; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/study.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/study.pdf).
- <sup>114</sup> Reading list (*tiplijst*) of the Week van het Verboden Boek [Week of the Banned Book] 2026, a campaign of Probiblio, CPNB, PEN Netherlands, de Schrijverscentrale and the Koninklijke Boekverkopersbond; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/tiplijst.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/tiplijst.pdf).
- <sup>115</sup> Joint catalogue of the Defence libraries (Royal Military Academy, Royal Naval College, Netherlands Institute of Military History), records retrieved 23 March 2026; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/biebs2.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/biebs2.pdf).
- <sup>116</sup> National Ombudsman, telephone note of 7 October 1999, dossier 98.07789, on the military psychological examination; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/karakter.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/karakter.pdf).
- <sup>117</sup> Barbara Overduyn, *memorie van antwoord*, Court of Appeal of The Hague, 2 February 2016, point 36; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/memorie.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/memorie.pdf).
- <sup>118</sup> Letter from the Ministry of Defence (mr. J.J. Buirma), 6 June 2017: ‘I therefore consider your case closed’; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/buirma.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/buirma.pdf).
- <sup>119</sup> Exchange on X between Minister of Defence Ank Bijleveld and Giltay, 25 October 2018, in a public thread also addressed to Belgian Minister of Defence Steven Vandeput; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/twitter.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/twitter.pdf).
- <sup>120</sup> National Ombudsman, Report 1999/507 of 17 December 1999, section C.5; [www.nationaleombudsman.nl/uploads/rapporten/19990507\\_1998.07789.pdf](http://www.nationaleombudsman.nl/uploads/rapporten/19990507_1998.07789.pdf).
- <sup>121</sup> Email from Karin Vaalburg, senior legal counsel of the National Ombudsman, to Giltay, 9 January 2024; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/vaalburg.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/vaalburg.pdf).

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- <sup>122</sup> Mothers of Srebrenica, memorandum of grievances, 7 July 2015, p. 14 (in Dutch); [https://vandiepen.com/wp-content/uploads/2023/07/15-mvs\\_grieven\\_7-7-2015.pdf](https://vandiepen.com/wp-content/uploads/2023/07/15-mvs_grieven_7-7-2015.pdf).
- <sup>123</sup> Court of Appeal of The Hague, judgment of 12 April 2016, ECLI:NL:GHDHA:2016:870; <https://deeplink.rechtspraak.nl/uitspraak?id=ECLI:NL:GHDHA:2016:870>.
- <sup>124</sup> Letter from the parliamentary Standing Committee on Defence to Giltay, 18 September 2017, ref. 2017Z09359/2017D25719, 'Verzoek om opheldering over Srebrenica-doofpotaffaire' [Request for clarification of the Srebrenica cover-up affair], recording the committee's decision of 14 September 2017 to ask the Minister of Defence for a response to Giltay's letter of 1 June 2017; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/commissie.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/commissie.pdf).
- <sup>125</sup> Letter from the Minister of Justice and Security to Giltay, 12 January 2021, ref. 3175305, in reply to his letter of 23 November 2020 asking whether the classifications in Dreigingsbeeld Terrorisme Nederland 53 applied to his book 'or myself'; both letters are in the PDF; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/justitie.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/justitie.pdf).
- <sup>126</sup> Email from Karin Vaalburg, senior legal counsel of the National Ombudsman, to Giltay, 9 January 2024; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/vaalburg.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/vaalburg.pdf).
- <sup>127</sup> District Court of The Hague (preliminary relief judge), judgment of 18 July 2023, cases SGR 23/4662 and SGR 23/4663, ECLI:NL:RBDHA:2023:17841; <https://deeplink.rechtspraak.nl/uitspraak?id=ECLI:NL:RBDHA:2023:17841>.
- <sup>128</sup> Extract from the personal records database (BRP) of Barbara Overduyn recording her death, issued via the CBG Centre for Family History; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/overlijden.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/overlijden.pdf).
- <sup>129</sup> Public debate 'Fallen | Cancelled | Mercy?', hosted by the American Protestant Church of The Hague and LUX Academy, Amare, The Hague, 25 March 2026, with Judge Solomy Balungi Bossa of the International Criminal Court; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/bossa.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/bossa.pdf).
- <sup>130</sup> Emails from Giltay to the International Criminal Court, 26 and 31 March 2026, requesting a response from Judge Bossa; no reply received; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/icc.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/icc.pdf).
- <sup>131</sup> Edwin Giltay, *The Cover-up General* (The Hague: author, 2024), pp. 142–143; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/book.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/book.pdf).
- <sup>132</sup> Balkan Insight, 'Netherlands Spent Over €2.6 Million on Fighting Srebrenica Cases', 21 January 2022; [balkaninsight.com/2022/01/21/netherlands-spent-over-e2-6-million-on-fighting-srebrenica-cases](https://balkaninsight.com/2022/01/21/netherlands-spent-over-e2-6-million-on-fighting-srebrenica-cases).

## Appendix: A selection of the media coverage

The coverage below spans press, radio, television and online media in more than a dozen countries across five continents. Country codes: AL Albania · BA Bosnia and Herzegovina · EE Estonia · EU European Union · GB United Kingdom · IT Italy · MK North Macedonia · NL the Netherlands · QA Qatar · RS Serbia · SI Slovenia · SR Suriname · US United States · XK Kosovo · ZA South Africa.

### 2014 – Non-fiction thriller

- Boekblad* (NL), Mandy den Engelsman, 'Coen Borgman start uitgeverij SpeakEasy' [Coen Borgman launches publishing house SpeakEasy], 24 November 2014; <https://boekblad.nl/Nieuws/Item/coen-borgman-start-uitgeverij-speakeasy>.
- EenVandaag* (NL), 'De Doofpotgeneraal: burger raakt betrokken bij spionage' [The Cover-up General: citizen becomes entangled in espionage], 5 December 2014; <https://eenvandaag.avrotros.nl/artikelen/de-doofpotgeneraal-burger-raakt-betrokken-bij-spionage-55812>.
- Leidsch Dagblad* (NL), 'Uitzendkracht klem tussen de spionnen' [Temp worker caught between the spies], 27 November 2014, pp. 2–3; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/leidschdagblad.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/leidschdagblad.pdf).
- Naša Bosna* (BA), 'Objavljena knjiga "Prikriveni General" o skrivanju filmskih rolni...' [Book The Cover-up General published, on the hiding of the film rolls...], no. 40, 28 December 2014.

### 2015 – Critical acclaim

- Amsterdam FM* (NL), radio interview, 5 January 2015.
- Boekenkrant* (NL), 'Interview Edwin Giltay', 19 September 2015; <https://web.archive.org/web/20220609064503/https://boekenkrant.com/evenement/interview-edwin-giltay/>.
- Checkpoint* (NL), 'De doofpotgeneraal' [The Cover-up General], April 2015, p. 29; <https://content.yudu.com/web/1r3p1/0A1zrki/CP1503/html/index.html?origin=reader>.
- Haarlems Weekblad* (NL), Johan van Someren, 'De doofpotgeneraal' [The Cover-up General], 27 May 2015, p. 7; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/haarlemsweekblad.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/haarlemsweekblad.pdf).
- NBD Biblion* (NL), review, April 2015; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/biblion2015.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/biblion2015.pdf).
- Nieuwe Revu* (NL), 'Duistere uitzendkracht' [Shadowy temp worker], review; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/revu.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/revu.pdf).

### August 2015 – Ban demanded

- Boekblad* (NL), Vincent Elzinga, 'Oud-MID'er wil dat exx "De doofpotgeneraal" teruggeroepen worden' [Former MID officer wants copies of The Cover-up General recalled], 4 August 2015; <https://boekblad.nl/Nieuws/Item/oud-mid-er-wil-dat-exx-de-doofpotgeneraal-teruggeroepen-worden>.
- Boekenpost* (NL), 'Oud nieuws, nieuw zeer' [Old news, new grief], 11 August 2015.
- Checkpoint* (NL), 'Reactie Van Baal' [Response from Van Baal], September 2015.
- Leidsch Dagblad* (NL), Silvan Schoonhoven, 'Ex-"spion" eist geld voor "boek vol rare dingen"' [Ex-'spy' demands money over 'book full of strange things'], 21 November 2015; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/schadevergoeding.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/schadevergoeding.pdf).
- Nu.nl* (NL), 'Ex-inlichtingenmedewerker wil verbod boek fotorolletje Srebrenica' [Former intelligence officer seeks ban on book about Srebrenica film roll], 2015; [www.nu.nl/binnenland/4100165/ex-inlichtingenmedewerker-wil-verbod-boek-fotorolletje-srebrenica.html](http://www.nu.nl/binnenland/4100165/ex-inlichtingenmedewerker-wil-verbod-boek-fotorolletje-srebrenica.html).
- OpLinie* (NL), 'Oud MID-er wil boek verbieden' [Former MID officer seeks to ban book], October 2015, p. 20.



#### 14 December 2015 – Total ban

*Algemeen Dagblad* (NL), 'Volledig vrij publiceren bestaat niet in Nederland' [Completely free publishing does not exist in the Netherlands], 5 April 2016.

B92 (RS), 'Holandski sud zabranio knjigu o Srebrenici' [Dutch court bans book on Srebrenica], 24 December 2015; [www.b92.net/o/info/vesti/index?nav\\_id=1078226](http://www.b92.net/o/info/vesti/index?nav_id=1078226).

*Bljesak.info* (BA), 'Nizozemski sud zabranio prodaju knjige...' [Dutch court bans sale of book...], 24 December 2015.

*Bota Sot* (XK), 'Gjykata e Holandës ndalon librin për Srebrenicën' [Dutch court bans the book on Srebrenica], 24 December 2015.

*Checkpoint* (NL), 'Boek De doofpotgeneraal verboden' [Book The Cover-up General banned], January 2016, p. 8.

*Danas* (RS), D.D., 'Holandski sud zabranio knjigu o Srebrenici' [Dutch court bans book on Srebrenica], 24 December 2015; [www.danas.rs/vesti/drustvo/holandski-sud-zabranio-knjigu-o-srebrenici/](http://www.danas.rs/vesti/drustvo/holandski-sud-zabranio-knjigu-o-srebrenici/).

*Den Hollander* (NL), on the book; <https://portal.denhollander.info/articles/34179?banner=oldsite>.

*Dnevni Avaz* (1) (BA), A. Hu., 'Holandski sud zabranio knjigu o Srebrenici!' [Dutch court bans book on Srebrenica!], 24 December 2015; <https://avaz.ba/vijesti/dijaspora/211372/holandski-sud-zabranio-knjigu-o-srebrenici>.

*Dnevni Avaz* (2) (BA), A. Hu., 'Casper ten Dam: Nakon zabrane knjige o Srebrenici pravdu ćemo tražiti do Evropskog suda!' [Casper ten Dam: after the ban on the Srebrenica book we will seek justice up to the European Court!], 4 January 2016; <https://avaz.ba/vijesti/bih/212758/casper-ten-dam-nakon-zabrane-knjige-o-srebrenici-pravdu-emo-traziti-do-evropskog-suda>.

*Dnevnik* (MK), 'Холандскиот суд забранил книга за Сребреница...' [Dutch court bans book on Srebrenica...], 28 December 2015, with front-page coverage and pp. 2–3; <https://web.archive.org/web/20170212020754/dnevnik.mk/?ItemID=791715F298C1054AAFDEB60703D0EC38>.

*Gazeta Express* (XK), 'Gjykata e Holandës ndalon librin për Srebrenicën' [Dutch court bans the book on Srebrenica], 24 December 2015.

*IE-Forum* (NL), 'Verbod op verdere verspreiding en promotie van...' [Ban on further distribution and promotion of...], 22 December 2015.

*Index on Censorship* (GB), 'Netherlands: Court bans book on Srebrenica genocide' (Mapping Media Freedom), 24 December 2015; [www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/indexoncensorship.pdf](http://www.dedoofpotgeneraal.nl/doc/indexoncensorship.pdf).

*Koha* (XK), 'Gjykata e Holandës ndalon librin për Srebrenicën' [Dutch court bans the book on Srebrenica], 24 December 2015.

*Leidsch Dagblad* (NL), 'Verbod op boek over spionnen' [Ban on book about spies], 19 December 2015, p. 5.

*Makfax* (MK), 'Судот во Хаг забрани книга за Сребреница' [The Hague court bans book on Srebrenica], 25 December 2015; <https://web.archive.org/web/20260228033542/https://makfax.com.mk/svet/evropa/sudot-vo-hag-zabrani-kniga-za-srebrenica/>.

*Mapping Media Freedom* (EU), 'Netherlands: Court bans book on Srebrenica genocide', 24 December 2015.

*Mondo.rs* (RS), 'Zabranjena knjiga o Srebrenici' [Srebrenica book banned], 24 December 2015.

*NOS* (NL), 'Srebrenica-boek De Doofpotgeneraal alsnog verboden' [Srebrenica book The Cover-up General banned after all], 21 December 2015; <https://nos.nl/artikel/2076565-srebrenica-boek-de-doofpotgeneraal-alsnog-verboden>.

*Nova TV* (MK), 'Судот во Хаг ја забрани книгата за улогата на...' [The Hague court bans the book on the role of...], 25 December 2015.

- Novi* (BA), 'Sud u Hagu zabranio knjigu o Srebrenici' [The Hague court bans book on Srebrenica], 24 December 2015.
- Novosti* (RS), 'Holandski sud zabranio knjigu o Srebrenici' [Dutch court bans book on Srebrenica], 24 December 2015.
- Politika* (RS), Младен Кременовић, 'Суд у Хагу забранио књигу о Сребреници' [The Hague court bans book on Srebrenica], 24 December 2015;  
[www.politika.rs/scc/clanak/346012/Sud-u-Hagu-zabranio-knjigu-o-Srebrenici](http://www.politika.rs/scc/clanak/346012/Sud-u-Hagu-zabranio-knjigu-o-Srebrenici).
- PowNed* (NL), 'Srebrenica-boek verboden' [Srebrenica book banned], 21 December 2015.
- RTS* (RS), 'Holandski sud zabranio knjigu o Srebrenici' [Dutch court bans book on Srebrenica], 24 December 2015; <https://rts.rs/lat/vesti/svet/2151990/holandski-sud-zabranio-knjigu-o-srebrenici.html>.
- RTV* (RS), 'Knjiga o Srebrenici zabranjena posle godinu dana' [Srebrenica book banned after a year], 24 December 2015; [https://rtv.rs/sr/lat/evropa/knjiga-o-srebrenici-zabranjena-posle-godinu-dana\\_673151.html](https://rtv.rs/sr/lat/evropa/knjiga-o-srebrenici-zabranjena-posle-godinu-dana_673151.html).
- Shqiptarja.com* (AL), 'Gjykata e Hagës ndalon librin mbi krimet...' [The Hague court bans the book on the crimes...], 24 December 2015.
- Sky MK* (MK), 'Судот во Хаг забрани книга за Сребреница' [The Hague court bans book on Srebrenica], 25 December 2015.
- Tocka* (MK), 'Судот во Хаг забрани книга за Сребреница' [The Hague court bans book on Srebrenica], 25 December 2015.
- Vesti* (RS), 'Marihunana je dozvoljena, ali ne i knjiga o Srebrenici' [Marijuana is allowed, but not a book on Srebrenica], 24 December 2015;  
<https://web.archive.org/web/20220519150602/https://arhiva.vesti-online.com/Vesti/Svet/541549/Marihunana-je-dozvoljena-ali-ne-i-knjiga-o-Srebrenici>.
- Villamedia* (NL), Lars Pasveer, 'Verbod op boek over verdwenen Srebrenica-fotorolletje' [Ban on book about vanished Srebrenica film roll], 21 December 2015;  
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## February 2016 – Appeal

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